FREE CALCULATOR · VA CHALLENGES EP 3

Lowball Rates: Know Your Minimum

Work out the lowest rate you can accept before you see an offer.

Item	Example	Your numbers
Monthly expenses	PHP 30,000	
Savings and emergency fund (20%)	PHP 6,000	
SSS, PhilHealth, Pag-IBIG and tax	PHP 4,000	
Platform and transfer fees	PHP 2,000	
Total per month	**PHP 42,000**	
Divide by working hours (160)	PHP 263 per hour	
Convert to USD at today's rate		
Your minimum hourly rate		

Before you apply

☐ Check 20 job posts in your niche
☐ Compare VAs with similar skills
☐ Niche plus results earns more
☐ Review your rate every 6 months

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Counter-offers and saying no

Polite, short and clear. Reduce the scope, not your rate.

COUNTER-OFFER

Thank you for the offer! My rate for this role is $X per hour. I can handle A, B and C from day one. If budget is tight, we can start with fewer hours and grow from there. Happy to do a short paid trial.

SAYING NO POLITELY

Thank you for considering me. This rate does not work for me, but I wish you the best in finding the right person. If your budget changes, I would be happy to talk again.

Lowball sign	Better answer
$2 per hour for full-time work	Give your rate and the results you bring
Free "trial" for exposure	Offer a short, paid trial
Many roles for one salary	A clear list of included tasks
No clear hours or scope	Ask for scope before any rate talk